

Fourth Suit Forcing New Minor Forcing Help Suit Game Try

FSF : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

NMF : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

HSGT : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣3

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥5

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣10

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠2

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦4

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 5 2

♥ K J

♦ J 9 3

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 7

♥ Q 10 9 7 6

♦ Q 7

♣ A 10 9 6



♠ K 10 6 4

♥ 5 4

♦ A 10 5 2

♣ Q 8 3

♠ J 8 3

♥ A 8 3 2

♦ K 8 6 4

♣ 7 2

NORTH should pass 2♥. She is not strong enough to try for game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by North

Lead: ♣3

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 10 6 3

♥ K Q J 8

♦ 9 5

♣ Q 8

♠ J 7

♥ 9 6 4 2

♦ A 7 2

♣ 9 7 6 3



♠ 8 4

♥ A 10 7

♦ Q 10 6 4 3

♣ A K 2

♠ A 9 5 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K J 8

♣ J 10 5 4

WEST knows there should be game, but doesn't know whether it will be 4♠, 4♥ or 3NT. To find out which she uses NMF and bids 2♣ at her second turn.

EAST does not have a 4-card ♥ suit, nor does he have three ♠s, but he does have ♣s stopped so he bids 2NT, which West raises to 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1♦ Pass

1♠ Pass

2♣ Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♥5

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 8 7 4 2

♥ A 6 2

♦ Q J 7

♣ 10 9

♠ K 5 3

♥ 10 9 5 3

♦ 9 8 6 4

♣ K Q

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 6

♥ 7

♦ K 10 3 2

♣ A 8 7 6 3

♠ A J

♥ K Q J 8 4

♦ A 5

♣ J 5 4 2

SOUTH cannot see a game unless NORTH has help in ♣s so she makes a Help Suit Game Try.

NORTH has 8 points and the doubleton ♣ K Q so he bids the game.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♥

Pass

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣10

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10
 ♥ A Q 10 3
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ Q J 6 4

♠ Q 7 3 2
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ A 8 7 6 2
 ♣ 10 8



♠ 9 8 5
 ♥ J 7 4
 ♦ K Q 10 3
 ♣ A K 5

♠ K 6 4
 ♥ K 9 6 5
 ♦ J 5
 ♣ 9 7 3 2

EAST has a perfect hand on which to use Fourth Suit Forcing. If West can stop ♠s, then 3NT would be a great contract.

There is one problem - if EAST bids 1♠ at her second turn it is NOT considered FSF, so she must jump to 2♠.

WEST, win a fine ♠ stopper, bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1♣	Pass	1♦	Pass
1♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♠2			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 10 5 2

♣ 10 9 7 6

♠ Q 7 5

♥ J 10 7 6

♦ A 8

♣ K Q J 3



♠ A 9 6

♥ A 5 4 2

♦ 9 6 4

♣ 8 4 2

♠ K 8 4 3 2

♥ K Q 8 3

♦ 7 3

♣ A 5

SOUTH's 2♦ bid is a perfect example of NMF. It provides NORTH with the opportunity to show either a 4-card ♥ suit, OR 3-card ♠ support.

In this hand NORTH actually has both. When that happens, showing the ♥s is first priority.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

Pass

1♠

Pass

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♦4